Evgenii Nikishin

New York City, NY
+1 (607) 262 50 38
nikishin.evg@gmail.com
github.com/nikishin-evg

Education

2019– Current — Ph.D. student in Operations Research.
Cornell University

2017–2019 — Master's student in Computer Science, with honors.
Specialization: "Statistical Learning Theory", GPA: 9.2/10.0
Higher School of Economics and
Skolkovo Institute of Science and Technology

2013–2017 — Bachelor's student in Computer Science, with honors.
Specialization: "Machine Learning", GPA: 4.9/5.0
Lomonosov Moscow State University

Experience

May 2020– Now — Research Intern (remote), **University of Montreal, MILA**.
Research on Reinforcement Learning. Hosts: Pierre-Luc Bacon, Yoshua Bengio

Sep 2017– Aug 2019 — Research Assistant, **Bayesian Methods Research Group**.
A part of **Samsung-HSE Lab**
Research on Deep Reinforcement Learning. Supervisor: Dmitry Vetrov

Jul 2018– Aug 2018 — Research Intern, **ETH Zürich**.
A participant of Student Summer Research Fellowship. Host: Gunnar Rätsch

Jul 2016– Dec 2016 — Research & Development Intern, **Kaspersky Lab**.
Worked with classification models for malicious software detection in executable files.
Implemented an autoencoder to extract features from textual representations of files.
Built an end-to-end pipeline for experiments with the textual representations.

Selected awards

2020 — Mitacs-MILA short-term research grant.
2019 — Cornell graduate fellowship for outstanding incoming students.
2019 — NeurIPS 2019 travel award.
2019 — MLSS 2019 full travel grant.
2017 — Fourth place in a reinforcement learning hackathon.
2016 — Russian state scholarship for academic achievements.
2016 — Second place in a chatbots hackathon at Yandex.
2016 — Winner of a blitz tournament at Yandex Data Analysis Night.
2015 — Bronze medal in Driver Telematics Analysis competition on Kaggle.

Publications

2019 — **Unsupervised Domain Adaptation with Shared Latent Dynamics for Reinforcement Learning**.
Evgenii Nikishin, Arsenii Ashukha, Dmitry Vetrov
Domain adaptation via learning shared dynamics in a latent space and adversarial matching of the latent representations of states
Accepted to Bayesian Deep Learning workshop, NeurIPS 2019. Code

2018 — **Improving Stability in Deep Reinforcement Learning with Weight Averaging**.
Evgenii Nikishin, Pavel Izmailov, Ben Athiwaratkun, Dmitrii Podoprikhin, Timur Garipov, Pavel Shvechikov, Dmitry Vetrov, Andrew Wilson
Average weights during training to reduce variance of policy gradient estimates
Accepted to Uncertainty in Deep Learning workshop, UAI 2018

Other research projects

2018 **Reinforcement Learning for Personal Treatment**.
Off-policy policy gradient methods for treatment of patients in intensive care units
Supervisor: Gunnar Rätsch

2017 **Hierarchical Imitation Learning**.
Generative Adversarial Imitation Learning for option-augmented policies
Supervisor: Dmitry Vetrov

2017 **Stable Matrix Approximation via Autoencoders**.
Autoencoder-based architecture for recommender systems with stability guarantees. Code
Supervisor: Alexander D'yakonov

2016 **Community Detection Methods in Social Graphs**.
Review and comparison of overlapping and non-overlapping community detection algorithms
Accepted to Lomonosov 2017 conference. Code
Supervisor: Alexander D'yakonov

Service

Reviewer, ICLR 2020, Inductive Biases, Invariances and Generalization in RL workshop at ICML 2020.

Volunteer, ICLR 2020, Women in ML at NeurIPS 2019.

Organizer, **DeepBayes** 2018, 2019.

Teaching

Sep 2017–Dec 2017 Practice Lecturer, **Higher School of Economics**.
Machine Learning classes for 3rd year CS students

Jul 2017 Teaching Assistant, **Coursera**.
Quizzes and assignments for Bayesian Methods for Machine Learning course.
The specialization of the course won Coursera Outstanding Educator Award

Technologies

Proficient Python, SciPy stack, LaTeX, scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow

Basic C/C++, Git, Bash, SQL, R, Keras

Additional education

Aug 2020 (Virtual) DL and RL Summer School, MILA, Canada.

Jul 2019 Machine Learning Summer School, Gatsby Unit, UK.

Jul 2019 Reinforcement Learning Summer School, INRIA, France.

Mar 2017 Spring school "Structural Inference", Humboldt University, Germany.

Feb 2017 Winter school on Reinforcement Learning, MIPT, Russia.